

Practice Paper 1: Authoritarian States: USSR

World History Topic – Authoritarian States: Stalin's Rise and Consolidation of Power

Read sources A to D and answer questions 1 to 4. The sources and questions relate to Stalin's Rise and Consolidation of Power: 1924 to 1938

Source A

Joseph Stalin, "The Tasks of Economic Executives," speech to industrial managers (February 1931).

"We are fifty to one hundred years behind the advanced countries. We must make good this distance in ten years. Either we do it, or we shall be crushed. That is why we must put an end to the rotten chatter about slow tempos. The history of old Russia consisted, among other things, in her being beaten for her backwardness... We must close this gap in ten years. Either we do it, or we shall go under."

Source B

Karpovsky, Soviet propaganda poster, "Long Live the Komsomol Generation!" (1948).



Source C

Sheila Fitzpatrick, historian, writing in *Everyday Stalinism* (1999).

"Stalin's consolidation of power relied less on ideological persuasion than on a relentless combination of coercion and mobilization. The purges and show trials of the 1930s were not simply tools of repression but also rituals of renewal, redefining who belonged to the socialist project. This paradoxically strengthened Stalin's position by giving ordinary citizens a stake in the revolutionary transformation. Participation in denunciations, collective farms, and mass campaigns tied millions to the regime."

Source D

Robert Conquest, historian, writing in *The Great Terror: A Reassessment* (1990).

"The methods by which Stalin gained and retained power were those of a despot. The purges and fabricated trials removed real and imagined rivals, eliminating the generation of Old Bolsheviks who might have opposed him. The NKVD's apparatus of terror destroyed independent thought. Far from being popular mobilization, these purges were a calculated strategy to create a climate of fear that allowed Stalin's personal dictatorship to reign unchallenged."

Questions

Question 1: (a) What, according to Source A, was Stalin's justification for rapid industrialization and transformation of the USSR? [3 marks]

Question 1 (b) What does Source B suggest about how Stalin consolidated his power? [2 marks]

Question 2

With reference to its origin, purpose and content, analyse the value and limitations of Source C for a historian studying Stalin's methods of consolidating power. [4 marks]

Question 3

Compare and contrast what Sources C and D reveal about the role of terror and popular participation in Stalin's consolidation of power. [6 marks]

Question 4

Using the sources and your own knowledge, discuss the methods Stalin used to gain and consolidate power. [9 marks]

RYAN

15/24 79/100

2/3

Same as Point 1

One justification Stalin used was the ^{or, but could be specific in stating "50 to 100 years" behind} lagging behind in Russia's backwardness in industrialization compared to other western countries. Another justification was Russia's historical precedent in being backwards in domains of science, technology, and industrialization when compared to others. Another justification is the imminent threat of other more advanced countries in attacking and winning over ~~Russia~~ Russia, a many-time beaten and humiliated Russia. *Try to use at least 1 word in your response.*

1/2

Source B suggests that Stalin relied heavily on propaganda ^{from the source} containing elements of communism in order to legitimize his power. The emotive slogan, pictures of Stalin and Lenin, and the pictogram of the hammer and sickle all symbolizes Stalin and his rule as a manifestation of communism and legitimized his rule over a communist-hoping generation. *Missing the 2nd Point*

Excellent framing & Sign Postings for 1st & 2nd

3/4

One value of the origins of Source C is the ~~comprehensive~~ ~~comprehensive~~ hindsight that it can give to historians studying Stalin. The fact that this book was written in the aftermath of the USSR's collapse ~~means that~~ ~~there is no~~ ~~the text~~ and decades after Stalin's death means that the full repercussions of Stalin's actions and policies can be realized without much possibility of bias ~~from~~ ^{careful using "full"} motivated for or against Stalin's regime.

One value of the content of Source C is its comprehensive and uncharged tone that suggests ~~subjectivity~~ objectivity to historians attempting an unbiased view on the source writer. Words such as "consolidation", "redefining", and "strengthened" all paint a word, specific but uncharged deliberation of ~~the~~ this history, can ~~help~~ help historians understand Stalin's means in an ~~unbiased~~ ^{This almost merges two different points. Be more specific on what it's balanced on (coercion & motivation)} illustrated yet unbiased view.

One limitation of the purpose of Source C is its ~~lack~~ lack of substantial details that can really help historians understanding Stalin's ~~claims~~ ^{legitimizes her claim} ^{generally limitations don't help historians} ^{While}

1. This is more content
2. Really? ~~It~~ It seems more like certain evidence may be highlighted to prove her case (Persuasive)

You kind of hit the point here. it's a weakness

Fitzpatrick made an assertion on the ~~the~~ means and ends of Stalin's consolidation of power, this particular document does not contain ~~much~~ evidence, analysis, and context that could help a historian understand Stalin ~~more deeply~~ deeper ~~and not as a~~ than simply ~~asserting~~ ~~that~~ a historical claim.

One limitation of the origin of Source C is its chronologically removed distance from ~~the time~~ Stalin's regime, undermining its accuracy and value to historians. Fitzpatrick wrote this book in 1998, more than 40 years since Stalin died. The faraway-ness of ~~the~~ the regime and the ~~consequent~~ limits to information & evidence about it means that the historian's viewpoint may be incomplete ~~and not~~ and not ~~the truth~~ to what really happened.

3

3/6

A similarity between Source C and D is their ^{not a valid comparison} origin, both in the 1990s ~~the~~ the two works, both published after the collapse of the Soviet Union, which may have their creation encouraged by an extended ^{since} release of previously classified ~~for~~ contentious information. Another similarity is their deliberation on the Great Purge, ~~and~~ show trials, among other methods that Stalin used ~~to~~ to consolidate power and ultimately lead to repression of the Soviet people ^{close, but no citation}

A difference between Source C and D is their ^{not a valid comparison} difference in tone. While Source C is generally more composed and neutral in tone, Source D ~~contains~~ contains a more charged and antagonistic view of Stalin. While C used educated and reserved ~~words~~ ^{adjectives} like "relentless" and "paradoxically" ~~to~~ to depict Stalin and his policies, D used "despot", "fabricated", "destroyed", and "terror" that paints Stalin in a more emotive and charged perspective. Another difference is their views on how mobilized the public was in Stalin's plans; while Fitzpatrick believed that

this one is better



06AX04

Close to a very good diff.

4

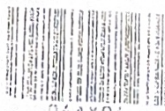
6/9

A clear, thematic thesis. It can be stronger if assuming why the members worked.

by compliance into the Soviet-constructed society that bolstered Stalin's control, Conquest wrote that the public were ~~unmotivated~~ ^{actively} bolstering Stalin's power, instead only subject to fear by the state. Another difference is the difference in their ~~description~~ description of the ultimate benefit from the consolidation of power. While C frames the ultimate benefit of the purges as the "socialist project" and "the regime", D is much more eager to pinpoint ~~the~~ Stalin as the ultimate state of power that all the consolidation of ~~power~~ served.

After Stalin's rise to power in the Soviet Union in 1924, the General Secretary had to face and rule the Union as a sole embodiment of ~~the socialist~~ the socialist ideology that drove the Bolsheviks into power. ~~Stalin~~ Most importantly, Stalin had to find a way to antagonize his opponents like Leon Trotsky, the ex-right handman of Lenin, ~~and~~ and win, and consolidate power. ~~Stalin~~ Stalin utilized ~~the~~ multiple ~~the~~ methods to gain and consolidate his power, including propaganda, public fear and purges, a cult of personality and standardization of arts and culture that ultimately drew Russians into support for Stalin, either out of fear or compliance.

Stalin's extensive use of propaganda in the public sphere normalized glorification for him and his policies, ultimately drawing support for the leader under the guise of communist ideology. Stalin ~~used~~ ~~profess~~ professionally used imagery ~~the~~ of himself, Lenin, ~~and~~ the hammer and sickle, and depictions of happy everyday Russian citizens. These pieces of propaganda ~~visualized~~ visualized ideas of ~~the Bolsheviks~~ of a glorious Russia under the communist institutions that ultimately was controlled by Stalin. As Russians, see the propaganda posters, they internalize such a glorious promise into supporting the Communist Party and Stalin, ~~and~~ ~~active~~ lobby Stalin's ~~power~~ support for Stalin and consolidated



Stalin's power in the face of the critics he controlled.

Stalin also invoked public fear into submission to his regime via ~~public demonstrations of public~~ ~~executions~~ ~~pages~~ and in public. Kirov's assassination ~~of that~~ was the powder keg for Stalin to begin public sentencing of officials, seditious demonstrators alike. The Moscow trials that ended up not ~~only~~ ^{even} killing all ~~of the~~ the defendants but those who were in the know about how it is a ruse effectively invoked fear ~~and~~ of arrest ~~into~~ Russian citizens, and by extension doing anything that sits outside of what's acceptable to Stalin's regime. ~~Under the purview of Stalin's fear-mongering tactics, Stalin~~ ~~subject themselves to him~~ ~~bolstering~~ ~~and maintaining~~ his dominance - erases possibility of dissent and ~~consolidates~~ consolidates.

People don't necessarily antagonize Stalin, however, even when they feel like their lives are in threat; that's because Stalin's ~~of~~ ^{and} out of personality helped to make him appear as ~~an~~ an all-knowing leader that legitimized the figure and policies that embroiled Stalin. Stalin permeated mass media and culture not only in graphical propaganda but also in statues, stamps, and murals, meant that ~~in~~ ⁱⁿ conjunction to deliberate propaganda, Stalin's face and figure has become a cultural token in the USSR, ~~often depicting him to a benefit~~ ^{often depicting him to a benefit} ~~particularly within the masses~~. This ~~generally~~ ^{generally} boosted opinion of Stalin in the public and ~~attaching~~ ^{attaching} ~~it~~ ^{as the public continues to see Stalin doing a few things, it} ~~boosted~~ ^{sustained} public perception of him, ~~leading to~~ ^{leading to} a maintenance of his ~~power~~ ^{power}.

But Stalin also imposed much more direct ways of ~~manipulating~~ ^{manipulating} funneling culture that served a ~~purpose~~ ^{purpose} to maintain power ~~over~~ ^{over} the masses. Stalin practiced censorship of books, art, and ~~entertainment~~ ^{entertainment} that didn't align with his ~~brand~~ ^{platform} of social realism. With institutions dedicated to create this kind of content and censor it, like the Soviet Writer's Guild, Stalin attempts to remove any content that ~~is~~ ^{is} in dissent of him and the Soviet ~~idea~~ ^{ideology}, ~~thereby~~ ^{thereby} avoiding chance of mobilization and consolidating power of culture. In continuously

along this, they maintain that power.

In conclusion, Stalin's grip on his citizens and inside the bureaucracy was lined with many methods of both physical and mental control. ~~There~~ Physically, Stalin killed thousands of people in public show trials and in the Great Purge. Mentally, those show trials instilled fear into the masses and the bureaucracy, and additional propaganda, censorship and Stalin's autocratic personality drew ~~the~~ him closer to the citizens, in terms of control.

- Be more explicit in citing your sources
- Good outside knowledge - however you lean too much into generalizing them, not standing by name.
- Some analysis, but still largely descriptive